

God Rest Ye Merry, Gentlemen

8th century or earlier; the London minor-key melody, printed complete in Chappell, Popular Music of the Olden Time, 1855

$\text{♩} = 160$

Am Am E7 Am Em F C F E Am Dm E Am

5 Am E7 Am Em F C F E Am Dm E A

9 Dm G C F C F C E7 Am D7 G C G Am G

13 C F C C G7 Am E Am D7 G Am G7

17 C F C F C G7 Am E Am

The musical score is written for a single melodic line in 4/4 time. It consists of five systems of music, each with a measure number and a set of chords. The chords are: Am, Am, E7, Am, Em, F, C, F, E, Am, Dm, E, Am (measures 1-4); Am, E7, Am, Em, F, C, F, E, Am, Dm, E, A (measures 5-8); Dm, G, C, F, C, F, C, E7, Am, D7, G, C, G, Am, G (measures 9-12); C, F, C, C, G7, Am, E, Am, D7, G, Am, G7 (measures 13-16); C, F, C, F, C, G7, Am, E, Am (measures 17-20). The melody is in a minor key, with a final half-note on A in the last measure.